

KSHAMTALAYA FOUNDATION

The Beginning...



kshamtalaya

NURTURING POTENTIAL



Year 2016-17

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ABOUT THE ORGANIZATION

Our story begins with two protagonists, one from Gandhi Fellowship and the other from Teach for India Fellowship who had a vision to reimagine learning spaces. And they travelled, in their own paths to understand what really education is. They crossed paths in Uganda, far away from their homeland and their tryst with Kshamtalaya began. Their conversations, thoughts, arguments, vision and dreams took a shape and soon they began their work in *Bakhel*. They were joined by a Dance Movement Therapy practitioner who integrated mindfulness and social & emotional learning with school syllabus and designed sessions that made learning in schools and intrinsic experience by making students become self aware..

A year passed by in trying and testing their newly designed manuals and the team grew bigger with more protagonists. Currently a team of 7 and growing, Kshamtalaya, aims to build a space to nurture human potential. A culture of work that lives on trust, love and passion to see our vision turn into a true world. Where every human is believed to be a self-learner, understands his/her potential and lives a happy and productive life.

Kshamtalaya is a non-profit organisation founded to support school children in disadvantaged rural settings so that they develop into socially and economically active young adults. This document describes Kshamtalaya's program, which intervenes in the 5th grade to improve school enrolment, attendance, academic outcomes, and life prospects for the students in rural and marginalised settings.



OUR VISION

Re-imagine learning spaces which lead to social and educational equity

OUR MISSION

- (i) To nurture a cadre of leaders who will work towards achieving social and educational equity.*
- (ii) These leaders will support students by building spaces where integrated learning happens.*

OUR TEAM

Alokesh Sharma

Loves listening to songs, playing ultimate Frisbee and teaching.

He was a Teach for India fellow and worked with the Uganda government to create a network of inspired and motivated teachers that focused on improving child learning outcomes.

Vivek Kumar

Theatre artist, film lover, believes in the power of young people and loves playing ultimate frisbee

Engineering student, Masters graduate from TISS and a Gandhi fellow. He successfully replicated school leadership program based on the Gandhi Fellowship model in Uganda (East Africa).

Pooja Singh

Loves dancing, reading, trekking and practices mindfulness

She holds both national and international certification in dance/movement therapy. She was a Gandhi Fellow and was associated with Riverside School, Ahmedabad.

Neha Arora

Loves to sketch, write poems and meditates daily and also loves to give advices

She was a Teach for India fellow and was part of a couple of MNCs before her stint with the fellowship.

Richa Goswami

Loves to read and travel.

She is a TISS graduate and currently pursuing a Ph.D. She has worked with Government and civil society organisation in program design, curriculum and textbook development

Anjali Gupte

Loves reading and listening to music, enjoys embroidery and knitting

She has done her graduation and post-graduation in statistics and done her B.Ed from Vidya Bhavan. She has experience of close to two decades working in schools as teacher. She has been part of text book development for middle schools and a part of TESS developing open resources at secondary level

Soumya Bhaskaracharya

Singer, song writer, loves to play table tennis, badminton, cricket and travel

Has done her masters from Christ University in Bangalore and has 16 month work experience from *Headstreams* a Bangalore based NGO.

WHAT WE DO

- Facilitate sessions designed by integrating mindfulness and social & emotional learning with subjects in our daily interventions in classrooms. Helping the child understand the world around, first by understanding oneself.
- Build and contribute to a safe space where children can express their thoughts and imagination by creating, inventing and designing with the help of resources provided to them.
- Learning festivals, a weeklong or ten day workshops where self-directed learning spaces are created and culminated into a day-long extravaganza of showcasing the learning.

HOW WE DO

Our intervention in school setting includes both Daily Intervention and a workshop format, in the form of Learning Festivals.

The Daily Intervention

(i) Facilitating sessions for 7th and 8th standard students of government schools and private schools, where the facilitator is also a transformative change maker of the school. The how is simple, you let the child look within himself by helping him be mindful, by being in the moment, understand his emotional quotient and the child realises what makes him, what is the best he can be and how will he do it. All these answers the child finds through a range of activities, some of which the facilitators will engage the children in and some where the children design for themselves.

(ii) A Self Organized Integrated Learning (SOIL) space, for children aging 6 years and above which will be set up in or near the school premises provides the child with the resources and mediums like internet, farming, books and human resources that he can use to bring his thoughts and imagination into reality by creating. A space with infinite possibilities where children become creators, inventors, designers and build the space together with facilitators and the community.

Learning Festivals

Learning Festival was curated with the idea of providing young people with learning support to understand and reimagine learning spaces. The idea was to re-orient their understanding of education and learning spaces through putting them into classroom and supporting them in creating spaces where integrated learning happens.

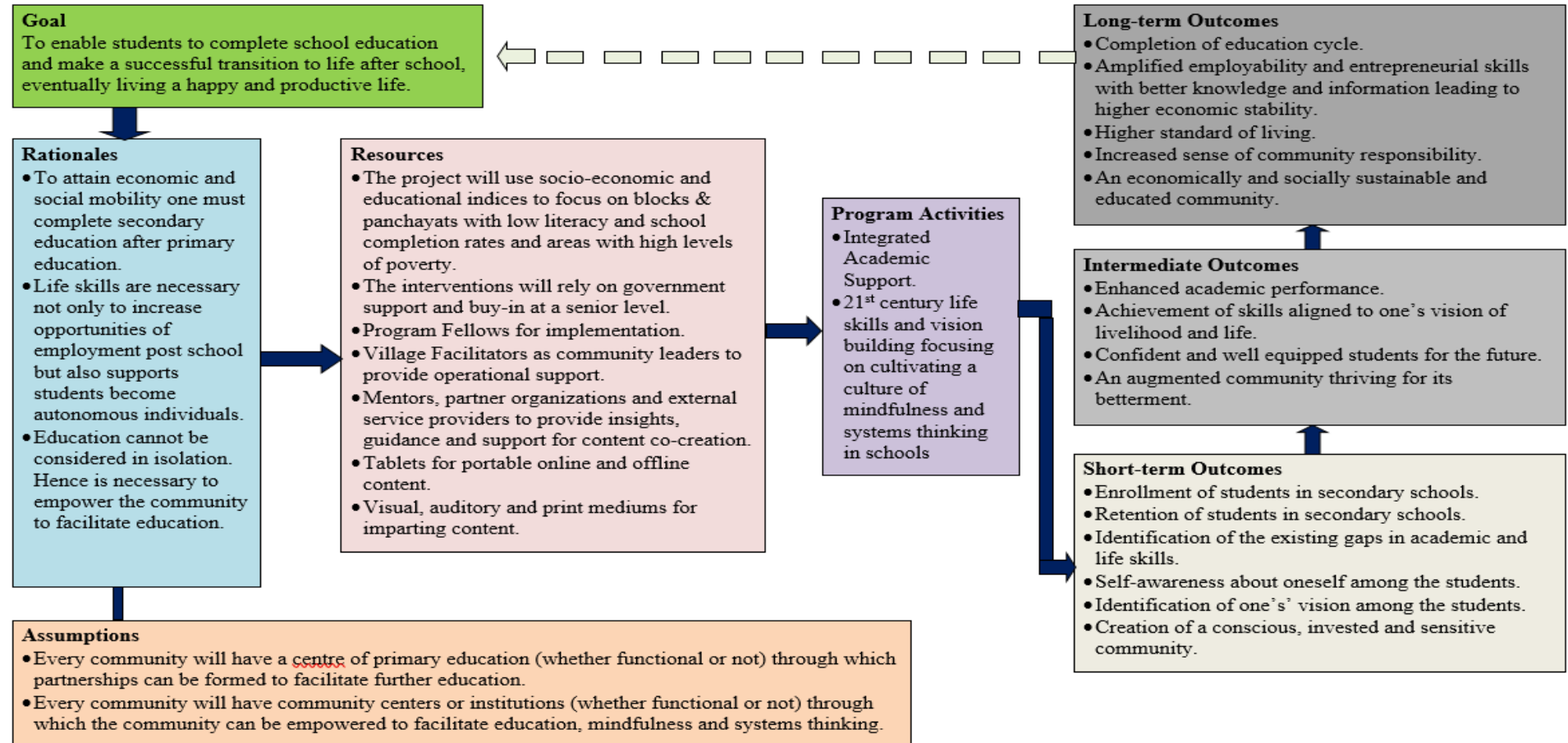
Facilitators choose projects that children enrol in by their choice and both the parties work together, learning from each other and designing it to create and build on each other's experiences.

Teacher Coaching

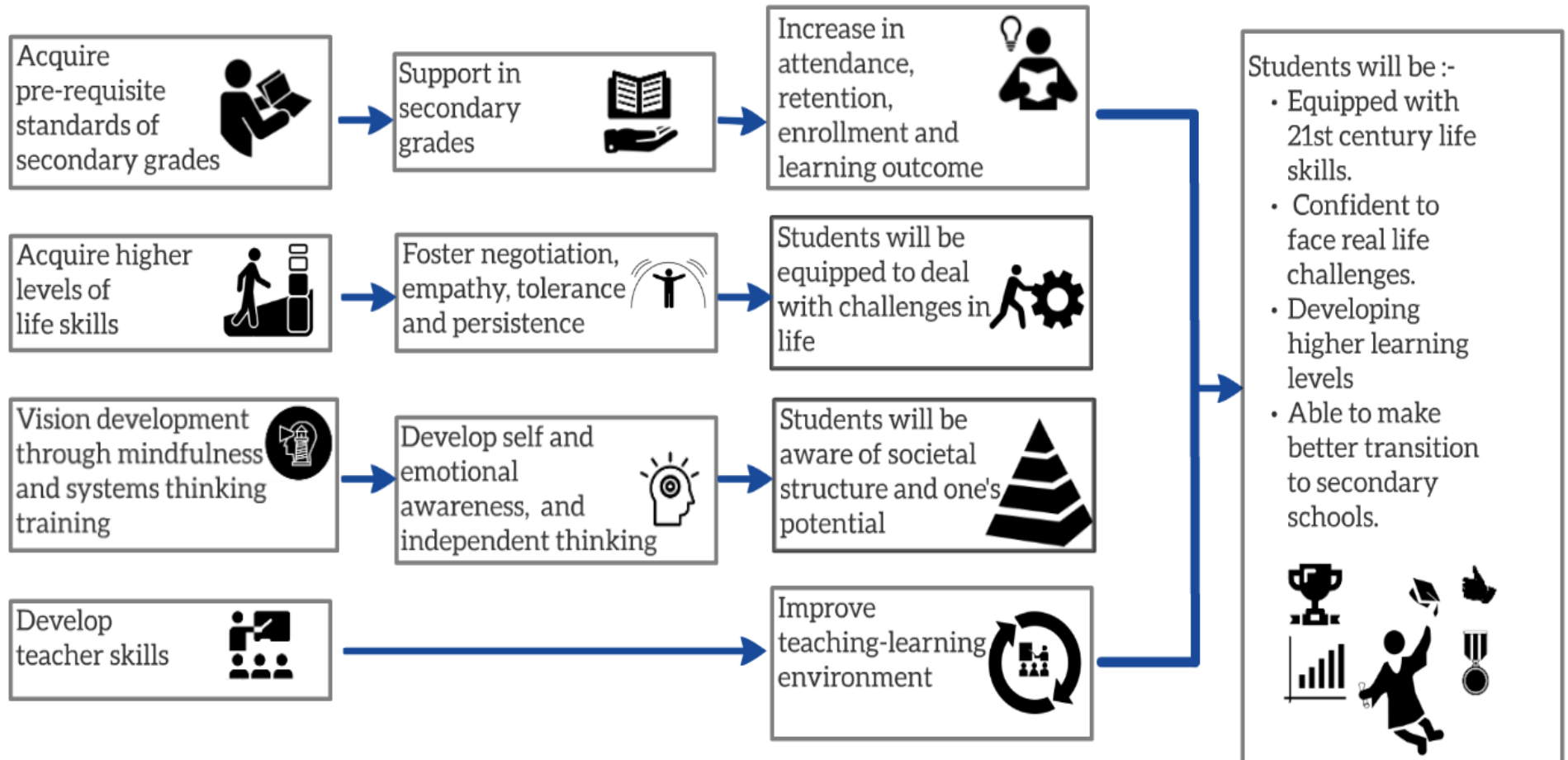
We believe that working and bonding with teachers can help us reach out to more children and scale our ideas and innovation techniques. Teachers make an integral part of the Education system and coaching them on mindfulness, systems thinking and social and emotional learning can create more meaningful classroom situation, help teachers cope with the work and lead a to a productive and happy life.

OUR PROGRAM MODEL

Problem Statement
230 million individuals in India are below the age of 25. 40% of students in rural India do not continue schools after primary education. This population lives in a rural set-up and is Below Poverty Line. This chunk poses a huge economic burden on the Indian state as they are unprepared and ill-equipped to earn their livelihood.



OUR THEORY OF CHANGE



IMPACT

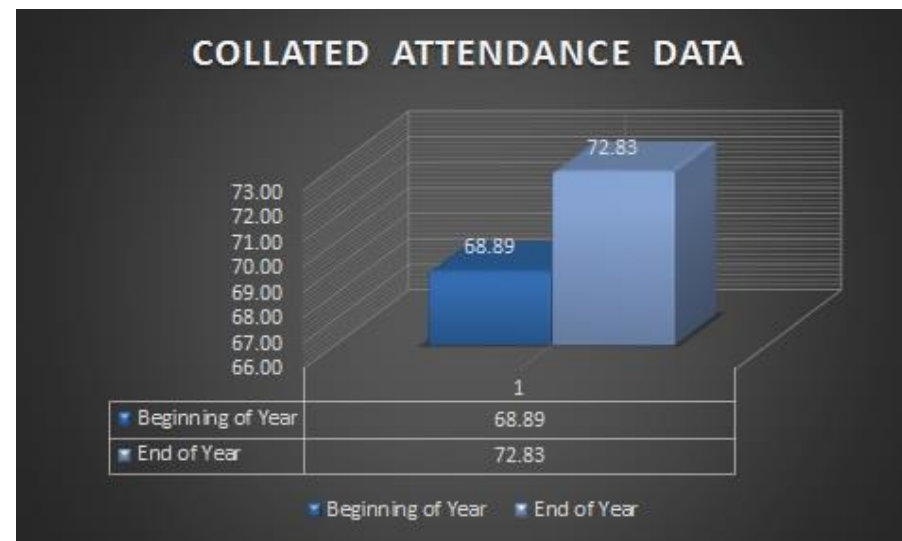
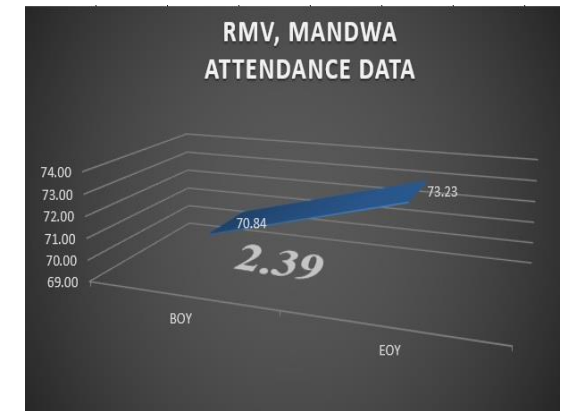
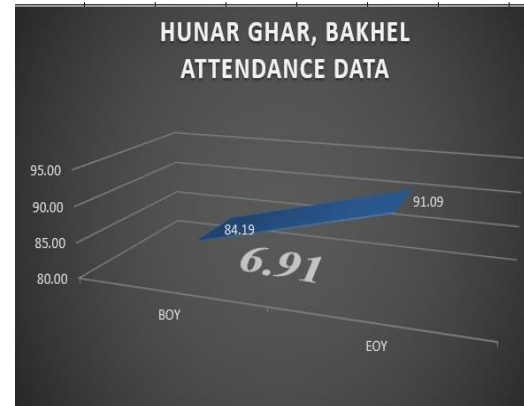
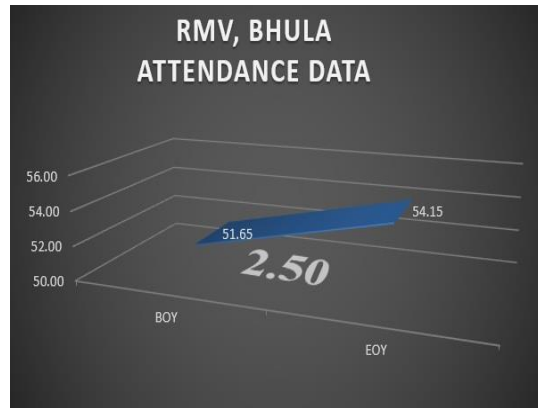
DAILY INTERVENTIONS IN CLASSROOMS

LOCATION: KOTRA AND DELHI

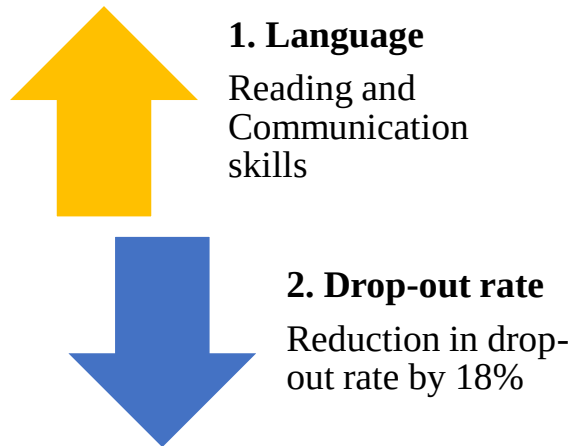
Classroom Intervention						
Name of School	Number of Sessions	Total Intervention time (Hours)	Total number of children	Class/Age Group	Intervention Area	School Type
Rajkiya Madhyamik Vidyalaya, Mandwa	116	136.5	45	Class - 8 / Age Group - 12 to 15 years	Language (English) and Social-Emotional Literacy	Government
Rajkiya Madhyamik Vidyalaya, Akhaji Ka Tiba (Bhula)	104	118.5	23	Class - 8 / Age Group - 12 to 15 years	Language (English) and Social-Emotional Literacy	Government
Hunar Ghar (RBKS) Ucca Prarthamik Vidyalaya, Bakhel	116	136.5	26	Class - 7 & 8 / Age Group - 12 to 15 years	Language (English) and Social-Emotional Literacy	Non-Government
Sahpathi	6	12	20	Class - 4 & 5	Language (English and Hindi) and Social-Emotional Literacy	Non-Government

Teacher Coaching					
Name of School	Number of Sessions	Total Intervention time (Hours)	Total number of teachers	Intervention area	School Type
Sahpathi	1	1	5	Language (English and Hindi), Maths and Social sciences Social and emotional literacy	Non-Government
Lord Krishna Public School	11 (along with on-going/weekly mentoring sessions)	22	12	Classroom Management, Defining Subject Objectives, Aligment of grade requisites with syllabus, Lesson Planning, Assessment Preparation, Different styles of learning	Non-Government

Average Percentage Increase in Attendance:



Qualitative Output of Our Daily Interventions



Two of the most significant changes that we saw through our interventions in classrooms is that children are now greeting in English, they are attempting to make conversations through English.

Also, the drop-out rate has reduced by 18% from our intervention in the last year.

3. Community Participation



The acceptance and love showed by the community was remarkable. They school were completely involved with the project team in constructing a classroom in the Mandva school in Kotra. It is a classroom that is truly made by the community, for the community.



TEACHER COACHING

A workshop was held in Delhi by Pooja Singh, with 16 teachers at EDMC teacher training institute of Tech Mahindra foundation on 30th May 2017.

Pooja took a session on mindfulness, body image and collaboration. During the de-brief, one of the teacher's shared, "This workshop helped me to understand my peers better, 10 years of togetherness with this institution yet it was through this workshop that I got to know my colleagues deeply"



LEARNING FESTIVALS

The Learning Festivals was curated with the idea of providing young people with learning support to understand and reimagine learning spaces. The idea was to re-orient their understanding of education and learning spaces through putting them into classroom and supporting them in creating spaces where integrated learning happens. A summer internship was designed in a way to culminate in to a learning festival in Bakhel at Hunar Ghar and Hansraj Devali hostel in Udaipur which involved interns taking up different projects. The projects were designed to create spaces which would provide children freedom to think, do, learn and reflect at their own pace and reflected every child's learning styles and motivations.

The Kotra Learning Festival was held in Hunar Ghar, a school located amidst the scenic beauty of Bakhel village gave a space for the interns to do a 10 day project where they each picked up an area of interest, designed sessions of three hours and worked with the children of Bakhel. The output of the project was to put up a fair or an exhibition at the end of the project where children showcased their learnings from each of the projects they were part of.

The projects included Theatre, Photography, Music, Art & Craft and Data Handling. The theatre project by Anjali Mohan and Rajan Lohia included sessions on voice, expressions, theatre games and performing a skit. The content was chosen by the kids of Bakhel and presented by them. The facilitators had imagined this session to be an outlet of emotions, students becoming comfortable with their body as they lose inhibitions and enhancing their creativity through working on story

building and scripts. The photography project by Arnojjashree was a creative one where children took pictures of things they liked that they saw in their village and wrote about it. The students selected their favourite clicks and put up their very own photo exhibition where they stood by their photographs and narrated to the guests their reasons behind why they clicked the photos. The Art & Craft workshop saw the children completely involved in making flowers, wheels and drawings. The facilitator, Daisy Meena saw this art form as liberating and a stress-release workshop where she wanted to create a space where children do whatever they want and be happy. Data Handling workshop, an interesting one where facilitators Tanya Goel and Naina Arora worked with 10th standard students and introduced the concept of how to organize any kind of data that is collected and communicate it to audience through graphs. The students as little researchers did an exhaustive data collection on how many children went to school, how many did not go to school and also the reasons behind it. The music workshop, handled by Soumya included knowing one another's songs, rhythm pattern exercises and making music using everyday objects. The performance included students using chairs, tables, empty pet bottles turned into shakers and sticks to create music where people couldn't keep themselves from tapping their foot.

The workshops rolled out during the day and the evenings were spent with the children where they showed their getaways and the experience gave the interns to see the village through the children's eyes. The sessions though had a few downs, such as festivities and rains which led to irregular turnover of children to school. But the children got so involved in the projects that they began prioritizing the Bakhel

exhibition and then headed to attend festivities and weddings post the preparations!

The day of the fest was a big hit. Amidst rains every hour, the children were at their fullest zeal to show all the guests that were present the kind of things they had achieved along with the facilitators. The guests included media house, representatives from other organizations, the village head, community members and new children who were not part of the project, were ecstatic looking at the achievement of the children. The dance, food and games room added to the fair-feel for the day.

Here are some photographs from the Kotra Learning Festival







kshamataya

**Presented by
Kshamtalaya
Foundation**

KOTRA LEARNING FESTIVAL

21st to 29th June, 2017

Supported by
educate for Life

'Bakheel ka Khel' a Mela organised by the children will be held on 29th June 2017 @ Hunar Ghar, Bakheel, Kotra.
Time: 10:00 am

Akadon ka खेल:
Data Handling
project

Udaan: Art and Craft

**Chitra se Mitrata:
Photography
project**

**Bakhel Theatre
Group**

Bakhel Music Project

Learning Partners

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Vivek Kumar +91 95496 48360

अनूठा विद्यालय | आदिवासी बाहुल्य मांडवा के स्कूल क्षमतालय में हो रहे हैं तब्दील, अब अंग्रेजी में बात करने लगे हैं
कोटड़ा के हुनर घर में बच्चे करते हैं ऑनलाइन डाटा हैंडलिंग

एचएच जैन | अजयपुर

स्कूल जहाँ बच्चों को मारपीटकर नहीं पढ़ाया जाता, जहाँ बच्चे खुद पढ़ने आते हैं, ये पढ़ते-मीखते भी केने हैं जैसे ये खुद चाहें, 12 साल के बच्चे यहां फोटोग्राफी, पेंटिंग, एक्टिंग कर रहे हैं, बस उनका मार्गदर्शन करने के लिए सर और टीची खड़े रहते हैं। यह हुनरवर स्कूल किसी राह में नहीं बलिक आदिकामी बहुत क्षेत्र मांडवा के बाबेल गांव में है।

हनुमत्पूज और धम्मपालिका स्वयं रेवती संस्थान इन दिनों मंडववा क्षेत्र के काखेल गांव में स्कूल में पढ़ रहे बच्चों के लिए 'कोट्टाया लर्निंग फेसिटिवल' मना रहे हैं। इस लर्निंग फेसिटिवल में आदिवासी क्षेत्र के छोटे-छोटे बच्चे अपनी ऐसी प्रतीभा का परिचय दे रहे हैं कि धरोना नहीं होता। आपको ऐसा लगना, मानो ये बच्चे किसी इंग्लिश मीडियम स्कूल के हैं। यहां बच्चे अंग्रेजी में बात भी करते हैं।

रुकनार को फेडरल के सम्मान सम्मेलन में मांडवा के 10 वीं कक्षा में पढ़ रहे मुकेश ने मंच पर स्वागत किया, वहीं भावना रेखा, अजय, अंशुपाल ने बेहतरीन एक प्रदर्शन कर प्रशंसकों को शिवा के महल के बारे में बताया। वहीं 7 वीं, 8वीं और 9वीं कक्षा में पढ़ रहे सुमुख राज, अतोक और मुकेश सनजोत, भार्गे के फूलों और कक्षा के बाहर दिखने वाली हरियाली को बच्चों ने फोटोप्रासी प्रदर्शनी में प्रजुति के विभिन्न रूपों को प्रदर्शित किया।

जैसे चाहते, वैसे पढ़ते आदिवासी बच्चों का, आदिवासी बच्चों के लिए आदिवासी बच्चों द्वारा अनूठा स्कूल

बच्चों ने बनाई
अप्रिकन लाइम,
लड़कियां ज्यादा
जाती हैं स्कूल

[illegible][illegible]

The Udaipur Learning Festival held in Hansraj Hostel for Girls in Devali, Udaipur was titled “Nazariya.. Ek Mera Bhi” as a project where the interns imagined a space where children would come together and show people their perspectives on various topics through the medium of photography, music, art and craft and theatre.

Photography project by Naina Arora was no less than an exhibition by any high skilled photographer. She worked on personal portfolios of the children where they made scrapbooks of 10 photographs each and wrote about the photographs too. There was also a display of Udaipur’s old city through the lens of the 11 girls who were part of the Photography group.

The Music project titled *Gaata Rahe Mera Dil* by Soumya was to instill creativity and let the children express on topics of their choice through songs. The children wrote two songs, and composed it on Friendship and School. Their songs were catchy and grabbed the attention of the public and they performed it in various places on the same day of the Learning Festival.

The Art and Craft Project called *Udaan* by Daisy saw children being involved and work so hard in making so many different types of craft items, using newspapers, colour papers, threads, old glass bottles, and turn waste into beautiful products. Also, they used their old socks, made puppets and performed a skit using all the props they made.

The Theatre group worked very hard and performed a strong street play on the issue of child marriage. Facilitated by Anjali, who has been a strong pillar for these girls throughout the skit where the girls worked together and performed a very bold script. Anjali believes that theatre as an experience is liberating.

On the festival day, slated to be held in Fatehsagar Lake a popular destination for people to spend their leisure day turned into a space where these girls took to stage and told people their *Nazariya* (perspectives) on school, love, hope, fear, friends, a day in my life, child marriage and enthralled the audience present.

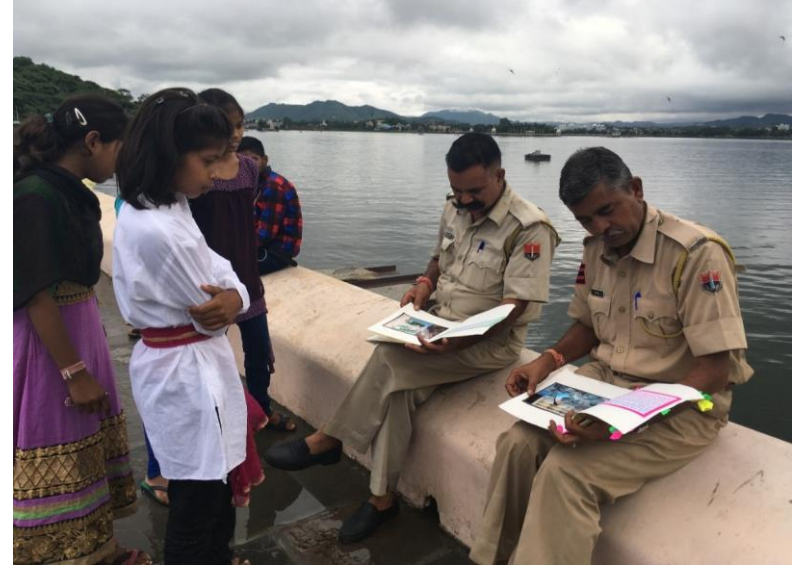
Post their performance in Fatehsagar, the children also performed at Hulchul Café in Shikshantar on the same day.

Below are some photographs from the Udaipur Learning Festival



The poster is for an exhibition titled "Nazariya... ek mera bhi". It is presented by Kshamtalaya Foundation and Rajasthan Bal Kalyan Samiti. The exhibition is by the students of Hansraj Hostel, Devali. The poster lists four projects: EXPRESSION: Photography Project, GATA RAHE MERA DIL: Music Project, UDAAN: Art and Craft Project, and JUNOON: Theatre. The location is Fatehsagar Paal, Fatehsagar Lake, and the date is 15th July 2017, from 05:00 pm to 07:00 pm. It is in association with educateforLife and JATAN SANSTHAN. Knowledge Partners are Children of Hansraj Hostel, Devali.





...चोटी एक बनाऊं या दो बनाऊं फर्क करे ना कोई

...चोटी एक बनाऊं या दो बनाऊं फर्क करे ना कोई

छोटकरी, झुंटीकरी आठ लारवाज में कानवली कल्ले कल्ले